

ONCE IS NEVER ENOUGH

Rapists commit multiple crimes on varied victims and often change the geographical area of operation. They mostly home in on people they know.

Based on Swanchetan's study on inmates of Tihar Jail

ing emancipation of women, who are now in public spaces on an equal footing. In theory, at least, because often society is not equipped to protect the rights of these young women—NCRB data shows that over half the women raped were between the ages of 18 and 30. Even those younger are not safe. In a case in Rajkot in May this year, a 15-year-

old girl, Diyaba, who was working with a caterer, was hijacked by Dilavar, an autorickshaw driver whom she had hired. Two unknown persons later joined him and she was forcibly given an injection that put her to sleep. When she got up she found herself in a room in Ahmedabad. Thereafter, the three repeatedly raped her for 18 days before she managed to flee from their clutches. Dilavar was arrested but the other two are still absconding.

What gives these men the courage to be cowards is the low rate of disposal of rape cases by the courts, with a pathetic conviction rate of 18 per cent according to NCRB. Even in the most publicised rapes, the assailants get away. Take the case of 2003 when a Swiss diplomat was abducted from outside the Siri Fort Auditorium in Delhi and raped in a moving car by two men. It was a major diplomatic embarrassment with about a dozen police-

men responsible for security of the area being suspended for dereliction of duty. Though the police carried out an extensive manhunt, even offering a cash award of Rs 6 lakh, the guilty were never caught. After five

years, the police gave up, filing a closure report in December 2008. A conviction is pending in an even more high profile case. In 2006, Sriram Mills scion Abhishek Kasliwal offered a lift to a 52-year-old woman



RAPE OF A US STUDENT Mumbai

APRIL 12, 2009

ACCUSED Six students, Vinamra Soni, Anish Borkataki, Harshavardhan Yadav, Jaskaran Singh Bullar a.k.a. Karan Singh, Kundanraj Norgonain and Dev Cyrus Kulabawala

DETAILS They have been accused of raping a 23-year-old girl who was enrolled in a short-term course in gender studies and development at the Tata Institute of Social Sciences (TISS).

CURRENT STATUS The accused are in judicial custody. The matter is pending in the sessions court.

DF VX



MIRA ROAD RAPE CASE Mumbai

JUNE 19, 2009

ACCUSED Parag Mhatre, Umesh Bhoir, Dilip Patil, Hiren Patil and Pritam Mhatre.

DETAILS Prime accused Mhatre allegedly befriended the victim seven months ago and promised her marriage. He took the victim and his friends to a lodge where they allegedly gangraped her. He then made an MMS of the act. Bhoir also featured in the clip.

CURRENT STATUS The accused have been remanded to police custody till June 29.

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